

The Hackathon Chronicles: How TiltShift* Was Born

Team: [ForknS](#) | Authors: [JudeCJz](#) & [Aswal S Ajay](#) | Event: [TinkerHub Useless Projects 2026](#)

4:30 PM

The Hackathon Begins (Solo Queue)

The hackathon officially kicked off at 4:30 PM. Meanwhile, my teammate **Aswal** took his sweet time to spawn because bro went for university badminton selections where he got humbled. (*Don't worry, he's taking the W on Monday*).

So I sat down and started speed-brainstorming ideas with **DeepSeek** (*DeepSeek is peak, by the way — fastest responses in the game*). My initial goal was to build a software project that leveraged unusual hardware already present in laptops and smartphones.

5:15 PM

The Failed Laptop Hinge Experiment

My first idea was a **hinge-based physics game** where moving your laptop screen would control in-game physics. It quickly turned into an absolute calibration nightmare trying to detect micro-hinge angles via the webcam. I realized early that this was a bad decision and abandoned it before sunk cost set in.

Time kept ticking. Between asking Claude, DeepSeek, and ChatGPT for inspiration, 6:00 PM rolled around with zero code committed.

6:00 PM

The Teammate Spawns & The Screaming Cursor

At 6:00 PM, Aswal finally spawned at the venue.

Bro pulled up with a concept for a chaotic, unhinged mouse cursor that loses its mind and screams at you if you don't touch your mouse for 5 seconds. We decided to split our bets — he started cooking on his cursor idea in C#/WPF while I kept searching for something even dumber.

8:00 PM

TinkerHub Community Break & The Veg Curry Rating

At 8:00 PM, the TinkerHub organizers and volunteers pulled everyone away from their laptops for a community event. We got dragged around to the basketball court, took a mental breather, and ate dinner:

- **Chapati:** W
- **Veg Curry:** 2/10 (*respectfully*)

9:00 PM

The Epiphany: "Why Don't We Let the Phone Pose?"

After dinner, the realization hit me: Every camera app in human history exists for people to pose in front of it. Humans tilt their heads, strike flattering angles, and pout. Meanwhile, the smartphone — with its precision gyroscopes, magnetometers, and lenses — is held dead-flat like an obedient serving tray.

What if, for once in history, the phone gets to strike dramatic poses and refuses to take photos until the human obeys? We officially kicked off development on TiltShift*.

11:00 PM

Prototyping at Light Speed with Antigravity & ADB

Using **Google Antigravity IDE** paired with USB Debugging and live ADB hot-deployments on physical Android hardware, the core TiltShift* prototype came together rapidly:

- Fused Sensor.TYPE_ROTATION_VECTOR tracking real-time pitch, azimuth, and zoom tolerances.
- Live tactile shutter locks.
- Real-time high-contrast savage roast engine insulting your crooked posture.

1:00 AM

Mentor Infiltration & The Merger

Mentors started circling the tables to review progress. We showed both demos: Aswal demoed the screaming cursor, and I demoed the locked **TiltShift*** camera demanding 45° tilt and 270° West alignment with savage roasts.

The TiltShift* demo was such absolute fire and comedic gold that Aswal immediately scrapped the cursor project and merged forces onto TiltShift* (*as we should have from the beginning!*).

3:00 AM

The Sprite Sheet Loading Screen Hustle

We wanted a hand-drawn doodle aesthetic. We created a custom stickman photographer with dynamic crayon loading bar sprites. Setting up the multi-frame sprite sheet animation in Jetpack Compose was a PAIN IN THE A** to calibrate, but with Antigravity's rapid UI iterations, it turned out gorgeous.

Aswal spent the graveyard shift grinding through UI polish, Lucide vector icons, "Baby Mode" semi-transparent assistive reticles, and the **Useless Peaktures Gallery** browser.

5:30 AM

The Viral LinkedIn Clout Engine (Empowering the People)

Because complying with a smartphone's geometric demands is an undeniable hustle milestone, we built the **Instant LinkedIn Clout Engine** — automatically transforming user struggles into viral corporate thought

leadership flexes (*"I missed the angle by 18°, the app called me a horizontal amateur, VC invested \$5M on the spot"*). You can now farm impressions directly from your camera gallery.

8:30 AM

Breakfast & Final Release

- **Breakfast Review:** 3/10 (*very fire, energized the final sprint*).

Rushed back to our desks, cleaned up the legacy code, generated the final v1.0.0 release APK, and committed this entire chronicle.

Built with ❤️, sleep deprivation, and sheer stubbornness by Team ForknS (Jude & Aswal) at TinkerHub Useless Projects 2026.